

- 63.** S₁: It is generally assumed by the admirers of democracy that the right to vote also confers a right for power which threatens the very existence of democracy.
- S₆: As a result, the political scene witnesses endless dogfights for power which threatens the very existence of democracy.
- P: These qualities are very rare and cannot be had for the wishing.
- Q: For the right for power must, if it is to be useful, be accompanied by the ability to exercise it with competence, wisdom, foresight and broadmindedness.
- R: Yet all those who have the right to vote believe that they have them and try by hook or crook to capture power.
- S: The former has much to commend it but one cannot be so sure about the latter.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) PQRS (b) SQPR
(c) PRQS (d) RQPS

- 64.** S₁: There are several tribes in East Africa.
- S₆: All the other tribes were afraid of them because of their skill in war.
- P: The Masais were famous fighters.
- Q: They used to raid the neighbouring tribes and carry away their cattle.
- R: They lived on the wide plains in Southern Kenya and Northern Tanzania.
- S: But the most famous among them is Masai tribe.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) SPRQ (b) PRQS
(c) RQSP (d) QRPS
- 65.** S₁: I had my eye especially on the long jump.
- S₆: He turned out to be a German named Luz Long.
- P: Everyone expected me to win that Olympic event hands down.
- Q: I was in for a surprise.

- R: When the time came for the long jump trials, I was startled to see a tall boy hitting the pit at almost 26 feet on his practice leaps.
- S: A year before, I had set the world record of 26 feet 3 inches.

The proper sequence should be
(a) PQRS (b) PSQR
(c) PRSQ (d) SRPQ

2015 (I)

- 66.** S₁: While teaching in the class room, our teacher suddenly fainted.
- S₆: The headmaster at once sanctioned his leave.
- P: The headmaster soon joined us and spoke to them in a soft voice.
- Q: He was told that the patient needed complete rest for a month.
- R: He was at once taken to the hospital.
- S: The doctors examined him with serious faces.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) PQRS (b) SPQR
(c) QPSR (d) RSPQ
- 67.** S₁: The colonial powers had a very simple technique to rule the world.
- S₆: Partition was the culmination.
- P: They lumped tribes and people together, played one against the other.
- Q: India's provinces were more elaborately designed to play the game of divide and rule.
- R: Africa was divided, believe it or not, on the basis of the lines of longitude and latitude.
- S: They also purchased the loyalties of those locals who were needed as supports for the colonial presence.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) PRSQ (b) PSRQ
(c) SPQR (d) RPSQ
- 68.** S₁: The bank opened at 10 : 00 am.
- S₆: The safe was empty.
- P: The peon opened the safe and returned the keys to the manager.

- Q: The manager and the peon went to the safe in the vault.
- R: The manager and the peon looked into the safe.
- S: They were shocked at what they saw there.

The proper sequence should be
(a) QRPS (b) QPRS
(c) SQRP (d) QRSP

- 69.** S₁: The crowd swelled round the thief.
- S₆: They were followed by the crowd which left the thief alone.
- P: Suddenly he whipped out a knife from under his shirt.
- Q: The thief stood quiet, his head hung in shame.
- R: The two young men holding him were scared by the sight of the shining knife.
- S: They took to their heels.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) QRPS (b) SQPR
(c) SPQR (d) RQSP
- 70.** S₁: The old man wanted to cross the road.
- S₆: Holding him by hand, the driver helped him to cross the road.
- P: The driver got off and came to him.
- Q: He was fed up and was about to return.
- R: Then a car stopped in front of him.
- S: He waited for a long time.
- The proper sequence should be*
(a) SQRP (b) SPRQ
(c) QRSP (d) PSRQ
- 71.** S₁: The first thing you have to do is to speak with a strong foreign accent and speak broken English.
- S₆: Half a dozen people will immediately overwhelm you with directions.
- P: He will be interested in you because you are a foreigner and he will be pleased that he could figure out what you said.
- Q: He will not expect you to be polite and use elaborate grammatical phrases.
- R: Then every English person to whom you speak will at once know that you are a foreigner and try to understand you and be ready to help you.

S: If you shout, "Please! Charing Cross! Which way?", you will have no difficulty.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRQP (b) SRPQ
(c) RQPS (d) RSPQ

72. S₁: When a lamb is born, its mother may die.

S₆: If a means of overcoming this natural tendency is found, the lives of millions of lambs can be saved.

P: Thus, there will nearly always be both motherless lambs and sheep without lambs.

Q: However a sheep which has lost its own lamb will not feed or look after a motherless lamb.

R: At the same time, some new born lambs are too weak to live.

S: This happens in large flocks where many sheep give birth to lambs at the same time.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQSR (b) RPQS
(c) SRQP (d) SRPQ

73. S₁: People very seldom have everything they want.

S₆: Our decisions indicate our scale of preferences and therefore our priorities.

P: Usually we have to decide carefully how to spend our income.

Q: They may all seem important, but their true importance can be measured by deciding which we are prepared to live without.

R: When we exercise our choice, we do so according to our personal scale of preferences.

S: In this scale of preferences, essential commodities come first, then the kind of luxuries which helps us to be comfortable and finally those non-essentials which give us personal pleasure.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PSQR (b) PRSQ
(c) QPSR (d) RPQS

74. S₁: On 5th October, 1818, when young Lincoln was approaching his 10th year, his mother Nancy died of fever.

S₆: His total education at school comprised only about a year during which he, however, managed to master reading, writing, spelling and some arithmetic.

P: She was illiterate, but she brought with her several books, among which were Pilgrim's Progress, Sindbad the Sailor, Robinson Crusoe and Aesop's Fables.

Q: Lincoln always acknowledged this moral and intellectual debt to his step mother.

R: The following year, his father married Sarah Bush Johnson, a widow with three children.

S: These books provided Lincoln with a mass of knowledge.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RPQS (b) PSRQ
(c) RPSQ (d) PSQR

75. S₁: Crude oil obtained from the field is taken to a refinery for treatment.

S₆: Lubricating oils of various grades are obtained last of all.

P: The gas that comes off later is condensed into paraffin.

Q: This allows substances with different boiling points to be separated.

R: The first vapours to rise when cooled provide the finest petrol.

S: The commonest form of treatment is heating.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQRQ (b) RSPQ
(c) SRPQ (d) RPQS

2016 (I)

76. S₁: Once upon a time, there was a king who had a wonderfully nice garden.

S₆: In the trees lived a nightingale that sang so sweetly that all who passed by stood still and listened.

P: In the middle of the garden, there was a lovely forest with tall trees and deep lakes.

Q: In this garden were to be seen the most wonderful flowers with silver bells tied to them.

R: The garden was so large that even the gardener himself did not know where it began and where it ended.

S: These bells always sounded so that nobody should pass by without noticing the flowers.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPRS (b) SPQR
(c) QSRP (d) QPSR

77. S₁: One of the first things the learning of a new language teaches you is that language comes from the region of the unconscious.

S₆: The test of how much you know is : how much can you say without having to think how you are going to say it?

P: What is often meant by 'thinking in a language' is really the ability to use it without thinking about it.

Q: We, grown-up people, have to filter it through our minds—a much more laborious process.

R: That is why children learn a new language so effortlessly : it comes straight from their instincts.

S: But we cannot say that we know a language or know what we have studied of it, until we can use it instinctively.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQRQ (b) RPSQ
(c) PQSR (d) RQSP

78. S₁: For seventeen years she led a sheltered life in the convent.

S₆: Two years later, she left the Loreto Convent where she had spent many happy and useful years.

P: Her heart went out to the people living there.

Q: In 1946, she asked for permission to work in the slums.

R: Then one day, while she was returning from an errand, she saw the slums of Kolkata.

S: She felt she had found her second vocation, her real calling.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PRSQ (b) RPSQ
(c) RPQS (d) QRPS

79. S₁: Good memory is so common that we regard a man who does not possess it as eccentric.

S₆: She wheeled away the perambulator, picturing to herself his terror when he would come out and find the baby gone.

P: I have heard of a father who having offered to take the baby out in a perambulator, was tempted by the sunny morning to pause on his journey and slip into a public house for a glass of beer.

Q: A little later, his wife had to do some shopping which took her past the public house where to her horror, she discovered her sleeping baby.

R: Leaving the perambulator outside, he disappeared into the drink shop.

S: Indignant at her husband's behaviour, she decided to teach him a lesson.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PRQS
(c) PSQR (d) PQSR

80. S₁: Human ways of life have steadily changed.

S₆: Even if we try to do nothing, we cannot prevent change.

P: Ancient Egypt-Greece-the Roman Empire - the Dark Ages and the Middle Ages - the Renaissance - the age of modern science and of modern nations one has succeeded the other; the history has never stood still.

Q: About ten thousand years ago, man lived entirely by hunting.

R: A settled civilised life only began when agriculture was discovered.

S: From that time to this, civilisation has always been changing.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRSP (b) QPSR
(c) QSRP (d) PRSQ

81. S₁: In our youth, we are apt to think that applause and publicity constitute success.

S₆: So let us be initiated into the mysteries of maturity and be taught how to resist and spurn the lure of hollow shows.

P: The man who values the applause more than his own effort has not outgrown his youth.

Q: It is our achievement or work which wins lasting rewards.

R: But these are only the trappings, the ephemeral illusions.

S: One should concentrate on one's work knowing that applause will come unsought.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRQP (b) PSRQ
(c) QPSR (d) RQPS

82. S₁: My office sent an urgent email asking me to return.

S₆: It was evening before I could sit and write to my parents that I would be joining them soon.

P: I immediately replied requesting a few days of grace as I had to book the return passage, pack and attend sundry matters before winding up my establishment here.

Q: On the way, I went to the laundry and made sure I would get my clothes in time.

R: Then I rushed to the bank, collected all my money and made reservations for my return journey.

S: From the shop next to it, I bought a couple of trunks to dump my books and other odd articles so that I could send them away in advance.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PRQS
(c) PRSQ (d) PSRQ

83. S₁: Wordsworth knew the behaviour of owls in the night better than most of us know the ways of black birds in day time.

S₆: His great poetry owes much to the night.

P: Out of school, there were no restrictions on the hours he kept.

Q: No poet ever had happier school days.

R: He would skate by the light of the stars, snare woodcocks at dead of night, watch the sunrise after a log ramble.

S: Throughout life, he was an inveterate walker by night.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPRS (b) PSQR
(c) QRPS (d) SQPR

84. S₁: Science has already conferred an immense boon on mankind by the growth of medicine.

S₆: The general death rate in 1948 (10-8) was the lowest ever recorded up to that date.

P: It has continued ever since and is still continuing.

Q: In the 18th century, people expected most of their children to die before they were grown-up.

R: In 1920, the infant mortality rate in England and Wales was 80 per thousand; in 1948 it was 34 per thousand.

S: Improvement began at the start of the 19th century, chiefly owing to vaccination.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RPQS (b) QSPR
(c) SQPR (d) PQSR

85. S₁: The young traveller gazed out into the dismal country with a face of mingled repulsion and interest.

S₆: He quickly restored it to his secret pocket.

P: At intervals, he drew from his pocket a bulky letter to which he referred and on the margins of which he scribbled some notes.

Q: It was a navy revolver of the largest size.

R: From the back of his waist, he produced something which one would hardly have expected to find in the possession of so mild-mannered a man.

S: As he turned it slantwise to the light, the glint upon the rims of the copper shells within the drum showed that it was fully loaded.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) RPQS
(c) QPRS (d) PRQS

Questions from CDS Exam (2012-2016)

09

COMPREHENSION

Around 15 to 20 questions based on comprehension are asked in CDS exam. The questions are based on the given passages. For tips on how to attempt these questions, read the section below.



Comprehension involves a thorough understanding of the given passage consisting of one or more paragraphs. It forms a very good exercise for intelligent reading and judicious selection. It is meant to test the intelligence of candidates and their ability to comprehend a given piece of text.

Tips for Attempting Comprehension

1. **Skim** once as rapidly as possible to determine the main idea before you look at the questions. Do not worry about words you do not know at this juncture.
2. **Underline the Words** that you do not understand to facilitate a complete understanding of the passage. This will help you to locate the words later.
3. **Look Through the Questions Carefully** You are advised to maintain the order in which the questions appear in the test paper. Read intensively the portion relevant to the answer.
4. **Concentrate** on the vocabulary items and re-read the portions of the passage containing the words you do not understand to find out their meanings.

Usually, options are quite tricky or some options are closely related. Therefore, analyse the questions and answer options carefully before answering.

Answer strictly on the basis of the passage and avoid selecting general answers.